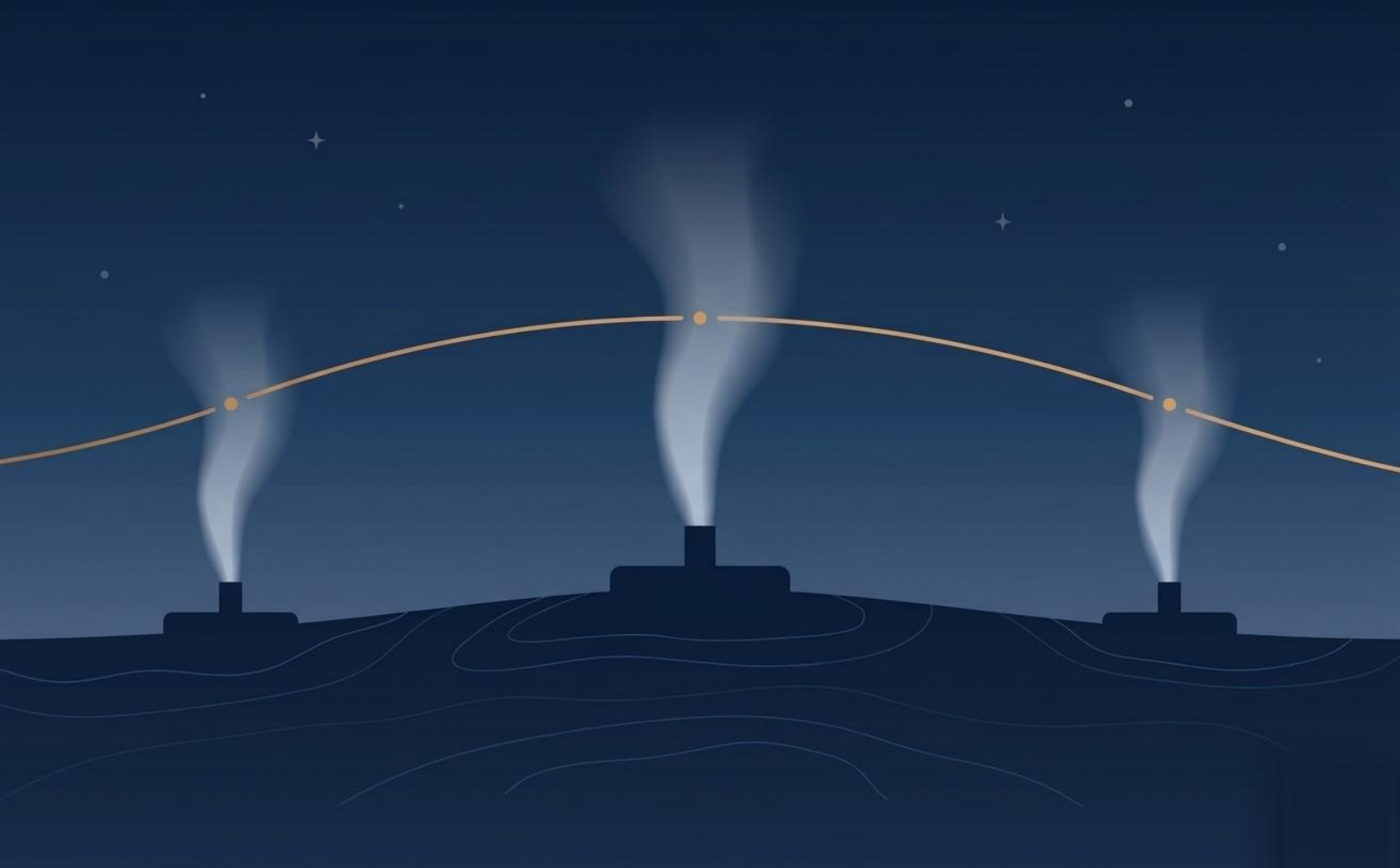




PORTFOLIO DOCUMENT 03 / ORGANIZATIONAL M&E SYSTEMS

THE REPORTING SYSTEM BEHIND A 25-DEPARTMENT CORPORATE WORKPLAN

From the Strategic Plan to a Department's Monthly Update, and Back

ILLUSTRATIVE DATA

GDC and its organizational structure are real. The figures throughout this document are not. This document describes a reporting system I designed and run at GDC. Every strategic target, workplan figure, and dashboard reading shown here is illustrative, built to demonstrate how the system functions rather than to disclose GDC's actual performance. The full disclaimer appears at the end of this document.

Role	Head, Corporate Planning & Performance Management Section
Organization	Geothermal Development Company Limited (GDC), Kenya
Scope	25 departments, 8 directorates, one financial year
My role in this system	Designed the departmental decomposition method, the dependency framework, and the consolidation tool; run the monthly and quarterly cycle

Context

GDC's corporate workplan is approved once a year. Then it has to survive twenty-five departments, each filling in its own share of it and reporting monthly, for a full financial year. Most organizational M&E systems succeed or fail in the space between a plan existing on paper and a plan actually being tracked, department by department, without the numbers quietly drifting apart.

This document describes the system I built to close that gap. A decomposition method turns a corporate-level target into a specific department's activity. A dependency framework names what a department is actually waiting on before a target can be hit. A consolidation tool rolls twenty-five departments' monthly updates into one corporate picture, so a department's own numbers and the corporate view always match.

What follows traces one real activity, with illustrative figures throughout, from GDC's actual Strategic Plan down to a department's monthly update, and back up into the corporate dashboard. The same mechanism runs across all twenty-five departments. Following a single activity keeps the connections concrete rather than abstract.

The Complete Cascade

Six layers connect a strategic objective to a department's Tuesday-morning update. The system closes back on itself; it isn't a one-way cascade.



Everything from the Corporate Annual Workplan downward is a system I designed, built, and now run in production. The Strategic Plan itself is GDC's real, existing document; nothing about it was constructed for this piece.

It Starts with the Strategic Plan

GDC's 2023–2027 Strategic Plan sets four Key Result Areas. Each carries a strategy, a set of key activities, an expected output, an output indicator, and a five-year target. These are GDC's real KRAs; the strategies, activities, and figures below are illustrative.

KRA 1 — Geothermal Resource Development and Management

Strategy	Grow the resource base by pushing exploration into new fields
Key activity	Carry out surface exploration surveys at Field A
Expected output	Surface exploration surveys completed
Output indicator	Number of surface exploration surveys completed
5-year target / Year 3 target	12 / 3
Actual (illustrative)	2
Lead department	Geothermal Resource Assessment

KRA 2 — Financial Sustainability

Strategy	Build revenue that doesn't depend on one buyer
Key activity	Negotiate long-term power purchase agreements
Expected output	Power sale contracts secured
Output indicator	Number of PPAs signed
5-year target / Year 3 target	4 / 1
Actual (illustrative)	1
Lead department	Finance & Investment

KRA 3 — Stakeholder Management

Strategy	Keep trust with communities living near project sites
Key activity	Hold quarterly liaison meetings in project-affected areas
Expected output	Liaison meetings held
Output indicator	Number of liaison meetings held
5-year target / Year 3 target	20 / 4
Actual (illustrative)	3
Lead department	Community Relations

KRA 4 — Organizational Capacity

Strategy	Build staff technical skills to match the project pipeline
Key activity	Run a corporate technical training programme
Expected output	Staff trained in core technical skills
Output indicator	Number of staff completing training
5-year target / Year 3 target	500 / 100
Actual (illustrative)	62
Lead department	Human Resource Management

From a Five-Year Number to Someone's Desk

A five-year target doesn't tell anyone what to do this year. Someone has to decide how much of it falls due now, and whose job it is. That step is easy to skip past in a diagram. Here it's concrete: three surface exploration surveys, due this year, handed to Geothermal Resource Assessment. That's the number that becomes a line in the workplan below.

The Corporate Annual Workplan

Three surface exploration surveys, due this year, are assigned to Geothermal Resource Assessment. On its own, that's still just a line in a strategic plan. The Corporate Annual Workplan is where it becomes something a department can actually act on: consolidated alongside every other department's targets for the year, organized by directorate. GRA's three surveys sit under Geothermal Resource Development, next to the drilling, maintenance, and infrastructure targets for the same directorate.

What this actually is, in production

210 activities, consolidated across 9 directorates, one financial year, budget reconciled to the last shilling before departments ever see their share of it.

Departmental Decomposition — The Working Template

At department level, “three surveys” becomes a real, trackable activity, the kind every department fills in for itself once a year, before any reporting starts. Every activity carries a measure type, describing whether it counts something, tracks a rate, or marks a one-off milestone, and a unit that matches what's actually being counted. Where a genuine dependency exists, it carries a named counterpart and a real date.

GRA's Working Template — the actual row, in context

Here's A-04 sitting among GRA's other illustrative activities for the year, so the connection to a real, populated departmental workplan is something you can actually see.

GEOTHERMAL RESOURCE ASSESSMENT — DEPARTMENTAL WORKPLAN FY 2025/2026										
PART A — ACTIVITIES DELIVERING A CORPORATE OUTPUT ILLUSTRATIVE DATA — dummy figures for a personal portfolio piece										
Ref	Corporate Output	Activity	Output / KPI	Unit	Measure Type	Annual Target	Start Date	Dep. Type	Depends on (Counterpart)	Required by
A-01	Resource base expanded	Conduct geochemical sampling at Field B	Number of geochemical samples analysed	Samples	▲ Cumulative	24	2025-07-01	None		
A-02	Resource base expanded	Prepare the annual resource assessment report	Annual resource assessment report completed	Report	● Milestone	1	2025-07-01	None		
A-03	Resource base expanded	Install temperature monitoring equipment at Field C	Number of monitoring points installed	Points	▲ Cumulative	6	2025-08-01	3 Service	Supply Chain	2025-12-31
A-04	Resource base expanded	Carry out surface exploration surveys at Field A	Number of surface exploration surveys completed	Surveys	▲ Cumulative	3	2025-07-01	3 Service	Community Relations	2026-03-31

That last row is the one that matters. GRA can't put a survey team on the ground until Community Relations has cleared access with the community living on that land. This is a genuine operational dependency, and exactly the kind of thing that's easy to leave unspoken until it's already cost you time.

Why the shortfall happened

Two of three surveys got done. The third didn't, because the community access agreement for that site was still outstanding when the year closed. The reason sits right there in the Dependency Register, dated, named, and traceable the whole way back to the KRA it affects.

The connection this whole system is built around

GDC's own Strategic Plan reporting already includes a standardized taxonomy of why targets are missed, and “Dependency on External Stakeholders” is one of its named categories.

The dependency framework in this system exists to catch exactly that failure mode, at the activity level, months before it could ever surface as a missed KRA target.

GDC's own strategic reporting identifies stakeholder dependency as a recurring, named cause of shortfall. This system exists to surface that risk while it's still small enough to manage, well before it could cost a KRA its target.

Monthly Reporting, and Rolling Up Into the Tracker

Every month, GRA reports its own achievement, spend, and the current status of that community-access dependency. Here's the actual monthly report: Section B tracking activity progress, Section C tracking dependency status, both shown with GRA's other illustrative activities around them.

GEOTHERMAL RESOURCE ASSESSMENT — MONTHLY IMPLEMENTATION REPORT (ILLUSTRATIVE)						
March, Year 3 Dummy figures — personal portfolio piece						
SECTION B — ACTIVITY PROGRESS						
Ref	Activity	Annual Target	Cum. Achievement	Status	% Achieved	Explanation for Variance
A-01	Conduct geochemical sampling at Field B	24	18	On track	75%	
A-04	Carry out surface exploration surveys at Field A	3	2	Behind schedule	67%	Third survey pending community access agreement
A-05	Reprocess legacy seismic data for Field B	10	7	On track	70%	
SECTION C — DEPENDENCY STATUS						
Dependency Ref	Counterpart	Deliverable Required	Required By	Status This Period	What It's Blocking	
A-04	Community Relations	Way-leave and community access agreement, Field A survey site	2026-03-31	Outstanding	Third exploration survey cannot proceed	

Rolling up — the same figures, sitting next to every other department

That report stays with GRA, but the same figures also get copied into the Corporate Activity Register and Corporate Dependency Register, alongside the other twenty-four departments' updates. Nobody retypes anything at this stage. GRA's own numbers simply sit next to everyone else's.

CORPORATE DEPENDENCY REGISTER (ILLUSTRATIVE)					
Dummy figures — personal portfolio piece					
Department	Counterpart	Deliverable Required	Required By	Status	Overdue?
Community Relations	County Government	Way-leave renewal, access road	2026-02-28	Outstanding	—
Geothermal Resource Assessment	Community Relations	Way-leave and community access agreement, Field A survey site	2026-03-31	Outstanding	OVERDUE
Supply Chain Management	External Vendor	Delivery of drilling consumables	2026-01-15	Met	—
Human Resource Management	Finance & Investment	Budget release for training programme	2025-12-31	Met	—

That “OVERDUE” flag isn't set manually by anyone. It fires on its own, the moment the required date passes with the agreement still outstanding, shown here alongside three other departments' dependencies for context.

What the Dashboard shows, without anyone touching it

Nobody updates the Dashboard directly. It reads off the two registers above and shows the position as it stands: GRA's 67% achievement in red, one dependency outstanding, one of them overdue. The picture is identical whether you're looking at GRA's own file or the corporate summary, because both are reading the same underlying numbers.

CORPORATE WORKPLAN TRACKER — DASHBOARD (ILLUSTRATIVE)							
As of 30 September, Year 3 Dummy figures — personal portfolio piece							
Department	Achievement	Green	Amber	Red	Dependencies Outstanding	Overdue	Submission
Finance & Investment	91%	5	1	0	0	—	Submitted
Community Relations	78%	3	1	1	1	—	Submitted
Geothermal Resource Assessment	67%	3	1	1	1	OVERDUE	Submitted
Human Resource Management	62%	4	2	1	0	—	Submitted
Supply Chain Management	85%	6	0	0	0	—	Late

Why This Is a Loop, Not a One-Way Cascade

Most M&E system diagrams show a straight line from strategy down to activity. This one closes into a loop, in two distinct ways.

The annual loop

The Tracker's year-end consolidated position, achievement against every department's targets rolled up corporately, becomes the raw material for the next Strategic Plan Implementation Status Report. The document reviewed to build this system, one year earlier, was itself an output of this same cycle.

The dependency loop

The bottom of the cascade feeds the top with more than achievement numbers. It supplies the specific evidence that would justify a non-achievement classification, if one is ever needed: a named

counterpart, a real date, a status that updates every month. An unexplained gap in a strategic report becomes a traceable, dated dependency.

Keeping It Honest, Not Just Designed

Building the cascade was design work. Keeping it accurate, once twenty-five departments were actively editing their own files, turned out to be the harder and less visible part of the job. None of it shows up in a diagram, so it's worth describing on its own terms.

The pattern that kept recurring

Departmental files are living documents. Rows get deleted to tidy up a template, activities get reordered, a column gets typed over. Each of those looks harmless on its own. In a workbook where one sheet's formulas reference another sheet by exact row position, any one of them is enough to quietly break the link between a department's Dependency Register and the activity it's actually describing. None of it throws a visible error.

What that actually looked like in practice

A formula that referenced a since-deleted row didn't fail loudly. It displayed a plausible result by coincidence, while the specific check it was supposed to perform simply wasn't running.

A dependency register that reported zero errors was, on closer inspection, describing the wrong activity on more than half its rows. The visible error count was a small fraction of the real problem.

A cell that looked blank on screen sometimes wasn't. A stray invisible character was enough to make a validation check misfire, silently, for months.

None of these are dramatic failures. They're the kind of small, silent drift that a system spanning twenty-five independently edited files accumulate over time, unless something is specifically watching for it.

What the discipline actually requires

Catching this reliably took three specific habits: checking every cross-reference against its actual source, row by row; rebuilding broken linkages from first principles; and treating every fix as unverified until it had been re-checked against real data. A clean error count wasn't enough on its own to trust. Patching whichever cell happened to be showing red wasn't enough to call the file fixed. Re-running a formula wasn't enough to call a correction proven.

This is the less visible half of running an M&E system at this scale. Six months into the reporting cycle, a director needs the numbers on screen to still mean what they're supposed to mean, and that takes more than good indicator design.

What This Demonstrates

One department's one activity is the example running through this document. The same mechanism runs across all twenty-five departments, every month, all year: the same registers, the same dependency logic, the same dashboard reading off the same numbers everyone else already typed in.

Designing the cascade is a results-framework skill. Keeping twenty-five independently edited files honest, month after month, calls on something closer to data quality assurance. The two skills are rarely demonstrated together in the same piece of work.

Full Disclaimer and Data Provenance

Illustrative data

GDC and its organizational structure (the 25 departments, the 8 directorates, the four Key Result Areas) are real. Every strategy, activity, target, and figure shown in this document is illustrative, constructed to demonstrate how the system functions, not to disclose GDC's actual strategic performance or internal financial data.

This document has not been reviewed or endorsed by GDC. It is a personal portfolio artefact describing a system I designed and operate in my role there, not an official GDC publication. Any use beyond personal portfolio purposes should be confirmed with GDC first.

The underlying system (the decomposition method, the dependency framework, the consolidation tool, and the data-integrity discipline described here) is original work, genuinely designed and run in production. The specific figures shown stand in for GDC's actual reporting data, which is internal.

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